

Position Property in CSS & Bootstrap

Concise Seminar Notes

Definition

- • The position property defines how an element is placed on a webpage.
- • It controls whether the element stays in normal flow or moves freely.
- • Works with top, bottom, left, right, and z-index properties.

1. Static

- • Default position for all elements.
- • Elements appear in normal order.
- • top, left, etc. have no effect.

2. Relative

- • Moves element relative to its original position.
- • Original space remains reserved.
- • Used to create positioning context for child elements.
- Example: `position: relative; top: 10px; left: 20px;`

3. Absolute

- • Removed from normal flow.
- • Positioned relative to nearest positioned ancestor.
- • If none, uses page (body) as reference.
- • Used for overlays, popups, tooltips.

4. Fixed

- • Fixed to the browser window.
- • Does not move while scrolling.
- • Commonly used for sticky headers or chat buttons.

5. Sticky

- Behaves like relative until a scroll limit is reached.
- Then becomes fixed.
- Example: `position: sticky; top: 0;`
- Used for sticky menus or headers.

Positioning Properties

- • top, bottom, left, right — define element offsets.
- • z-index — controls which element appears on top.

Bootstrap Position Classes

- .position-static – Default
- .position-relative – Relative
- .position-absolute – Absolute
- .position-fixed – Fixed
- .position-sticky – Sticky
- .top-0, .bottom-0, .start-0, .end-0 – Set offsets
- .translate-middle – Centers element

Summary Table

- Type | In Flow | Reference | Use
- Static | Yes | Default flow | Default layout
- Relative | Yes | Itself | Minor adjustments
- Absolute | No | Positioned ancestor |
Overlays, modals
- Fixed | No | Browser window | Sticky navbar
- Sticky | Partial | Scroll | Sticky header